

DISTORTIONS

New York University GSAS Department of Music Conference

Silver Center for Arts and Sciences

31 Washington Pl, New York, NY 10003

CONFERENCE SCHEDULE

FRIDAY OCTOBER 2, 2026

- 8:00 a.m. – 5:00 p.m.** **Registration** (Silver 120)
- 8:00 a.m. – 9:00 a.m.** **Breakfast** (Silver 120)
- 9:00 a.m. – 9:15 a.m.** **Introductory Remarks** (Silver 320)
- 9:00 a.m. – 5:00 p.m.** **Installations** (Silver 120)
- Skyler Zheng, *Vision Noise*
 - Bria Nachele, *Bridge Over Troubled Waters / Still Watters Run Deep*
- 9:15 a.m. – 10:45 a.m.** **Panel 1: Refracting Queerness and Femininity** (Silver 320)
Chair: Maureen Mahon
- Jaida Wilson, “‘I Wanna Take You Out Sometime’: ‘Sushi’ and Black Queer Nightlife in Eusexua”
 - Stella Seorin Bak, “Distorting Femininity in K-POP across Borders: The Transnational Reconfiguration of Body Image in TWICE”
 - Gillian Radcliffe, “Timbral Expressions of Gender and Sexuality in SOPHIE’S ‘OIL OF EVERY PEARL’S UN-INSIDES’ (2017)”
- 11:00 a.m. – 12:30 p.m.** **Panel 2: Temporal Mediations** (Silver 320)
Chair: Jaime Oliver
- Yanqi Chen, “Mediated Duration: Technical Memory, Cybernetic Operationality, and the Distortion of Time”

- Julian Day, “‘At Least I’ll Live As I Believe’: Peering Through the Dark Shades of ‘Pop Star Time’”
- Lauren Adamow, “She(’s) Got A()way: Temporal Drag in Chappell Roan’s ‘The Subway’”

12:30 p.m. – 1:30 p.m. Lunch (Silver 120)

***1:00 p.m.**

- Screening: Sawyer Adler, *The Sunset Scrolls: An Opera for TikTok* (10 min)

1:30 p.m. – 3:15 p.m. Concert 1 (Silver 220)

- JD Davids, Moira Williams, Forest Kamerin, *Care on Hold: Pharmacy Hold Music, Access Intimacy, and the Sonic Politics of Chronic Illness*
- Thessia Machado and Ranjit Bhatnagar, *slipgear*
- Lisa Ann Schonberg and Sara Wentworth, *Mount Right*
- Federico Balducci, *Dial Drift v3: System Signal Residue*

3:30 p.m. – 5:00 p.m. Panel 3: Warping Space (Silver 320)

Chair: Fanny Gribenski

- Sophia Cocozza, “Distorting the Environment: Carolee Schneemann and the Sound of Collision”
- Jenn Grossman, “Tracing the Blur: Exploring Reverb’s Psycho-Spatial Resonance”
- Jessie Monts, “Knowing after Postmodernism: Ecological Imaginings of Spatio-Temporal Epistemology in Jessie Montgomery’s Rounds”

5:15 p.m. – 6:45 p.m. Panel 4: Distorted Vitalities (Silver 320)

Chair: Clifton Boyd

- Seon Shim, “Distortions in the Brain: QEEG Brain Mapping in Neurodivergence Diagnosis”
- Ian Mahanpour, “‘The Digital Revolution is Over’: Oval, Mille Plateaux, and the Silence of Madness”
- Max Keller, “Halted Voices: AIDS Testimony in the K. Robert Schwarz Papers”

7:00 – 8:00 p.m. Keynote Performance: Ka Baird (Silver 220)

8:00 – 9:00 p.m. Reception (Silver 220)

SATURDAY OCTOBER 3, 2026

8:00 a.m. – 5:00 p.m. Registration (Silver 120)

8:00 a.m. – 9:00 a.m. Breakfast (Silver 120)

9:00 a.m. – 5:00 p.m. Installations (Silver 120)

- Skyler Zheng, *Vision Noise*
- Bria Nachele, *Bridge Over Troubled Waters / Still Watters Run Deep*

9:00 a.m. – 10:30 a.m. Panel 5: Paranormal Presences (Silver 320)

Chair: Annie Garlid

- Isobel D’Cruz Barnes, “Hearing Things: Haunted Acoustemology and the Sound of Supernatural in Post-Colonial Malaysia”
- DB Amorin, “Interference Events: UAP and the Mythogenic Field”
- Liz Jorgenson, “Digital Ghosts in the Analog Machine: Technological Failure, Sampling Loops, and Echoes of the COVID-19 Pandemic in Alex Kister’s *The Mandela Catalogue*”

10:45 a.m. – 12:15 p.m.

Panel 6: Audio Interference (Silver 320)

Chair: Joshua Biggs

- Alex Durr, “It’s Like You’re Really There: Liveness and/as Fidelity in Recordings of Independent Origin”
- Isaac Blumfield, “The Speed of Samples: Audio Playback Speed as (Artistic) Research”
- Mike Clemow, “Audi Pro Nobis: Field Recording, Dysmorphia, and the Post-commodity Condition”

12:15 p.m. – 1:15 p.m. Lunch (Silver 120)

1:15 p.m. – 2:45 p.m. Panel 7: Twisting Narratives and Semiotics (Silver 320)

Chair: David Samuels

- Jardena Gertler-Jaffe, “Jewish Opera? The Look and Sound of Jewish Difference in Bates’s *Kavalier and Clay*”
- Ellen Jeon, “IMDb Sorting Algorithms and the Semiotics of Audience Voice in *Squid Game*”
- Zachary Walker-Kahne, “The False Promise of Music in Dorothy Baker’s *Young Man with a Horn* (1938) and Michael Ondaatje’s *Coming Through Slaughter* (1976)”

3:00 p.m. – 4:00 p.m. Panel 8: Political Spirals (Silver 320)

Chair: Louis Karchin

- Lydia Rufin, “Dancing With the Devil: Music and Dance as Indicators of Social Inversion in Images of the Witches’ Sabbath in Early Modern Europe”
- Winter Craig, “Satanic Seal of Approval: The Parental Advisory Label’s Religious-Right Backmasking Scare Origins and Role in Democratic Campaign Strategies”

4:15 p.m. – 5:45 p.m. Concert 2 (Silver 220)

- Alma Laprida and Bryce Hackford, *Subwoofer Duo*
- Alexandra Berger and Allen Fogelsanger, *Static*
- David Acevedo, *NANO 1*
- Laura Horne, *To Which Do We Belong*

6:00 p.m. – 7:30 p.m. Keynote Talk: Mara Mills (Silver 320)

7:30 p.m. – 8:30 p.m. Reception and Closing Remarks (Silver 220)